



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 8 ISSUE #8
August 2021

COMING EVENTS

August

5th	General Meeting
7th	Central Coast Workshop
14th	Sydney Workshop
18th	Committee Meeting

September

2nd	General Meeting
4th	Retford Park
11th	Concours Workshop
15th	Committee Meeting

Please note that all meetings will be via Zoom until further notice.

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(Old) Boys Own Adventure

By Scott Graham



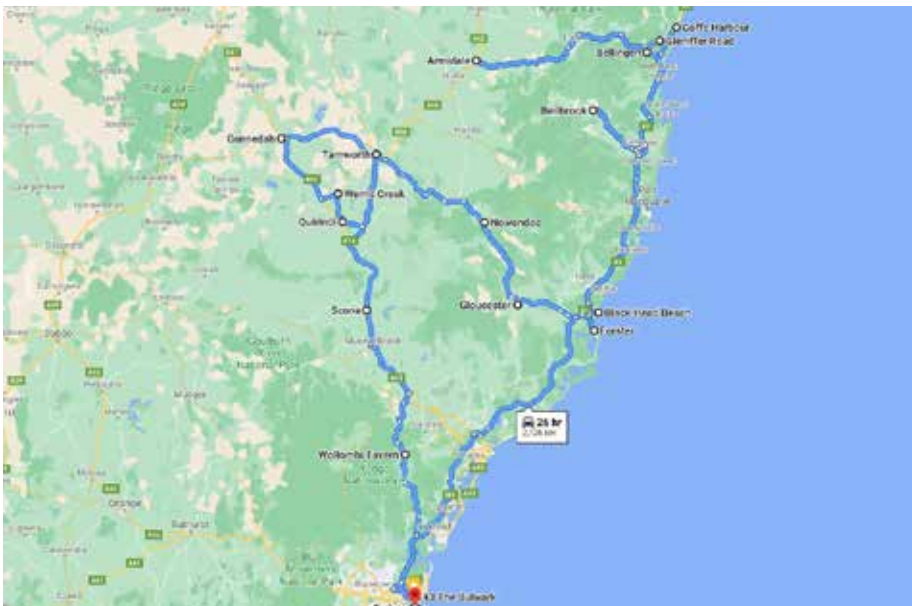
Back in the days long before Gladys' Lockdown II, some mates and I headed north for a well-planned eight day jaunt around northern NSW in our sports cars.

With getting to the start line preparation is everything, and I was determined not to be "that guy" who broke down along the way.

Two problems needed fixing, my trick DR3A Jaguar 'S' type wiper

motor was on the blink and out of the car, and my handbrake cable needed replacing. In addition, I wanted to update the fuse box to improve our chances, if we had an electrical problem, of at least limping to the next stop.

Gave it to my mechanic with two weeks to go. Frustratingly, he called me a week later to say that he had fixed the handbrake, but the wipers were beyond him.



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au

WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Normally our monthly meetings will be held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the restaurant from 5.30pm.



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

As I write, we are in extended lockdown here in Sydney. If you are lucky enough to not reside in the Greater Sydney area, we wish you well and hope that the virus stays well away from your neck of the woods, so that you can continue to enjoy social interaction with your family, friends and neighbours without having to resort to Zoom.

Being unable to do the things that we love now, will only make it that much more special when we are again free to hold club events 'in the flesh'. So, when you do attend your first face-to-face AHOC event after the lockdown, take the time to savour the moment and allow that feeling to sink into your soul. If we should have a further lockdown you will have a memory to treasure.

Sadly, our next face-to-face meeting is going to be at least a month into the future. On a brighter note, we are now getting quite expert at holding monthly meetings by Zoom. As nominal chair of the meeting, I am very happy for members to take

an active part in proceedings. Last month we had some spontaneous and entertaining chats with various club members, and it seemed to me that we all enjoyed the meeting. I encourage all of you to join us once again on Zoom for our next General Meeting, which will begin at 7:30 on Thursday 5 August.

The link to join the meeting is

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/89690407645?pwd=Sm-JPNVQrRStnYko2bnRHRGlSSGp-2dz09>

Or you can open Zoom on your computer and join:
Meeting ID: 896 9040 7645
Passcode: 297053

Hopefully we will see not only regular attendees, but also some of those who cannot usually attend our meetings at Strathfield Golf Club.

As always, I wish you safe and uneventful travels in your Austin-Healey and I hope to see you in



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

person at the September General Meeting, meanwhile please enjoy this edition of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*.

Gordon

COMMITTEE LIST - 2021

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
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gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

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0458 777 339
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0419 233 099
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Technical Officer - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
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Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Warwick Sell, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the August 2021 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

Before I started with this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter I wondered, that with Sydney in complete lockdown and therefore no club events, what in heavens name was going to go within.

I'm pleased to say that with the support of some fellow club members and others we have managed to put together 33 pages of what I hope is reasonable Healey and Austin-Healey reading. Yes there are the all-important reports and of course the minutes, but there is a lot more. A big thanks to Scott Graham for the article on his recent trip north into the inland of the state. I was pleased to reserve the first page for Scott's words and frankly I am not surprised that his BJ7 covered the eight days of touring without difficulty. After all that's what Austin-Healeys excel at.

There is an article on page 11 that rather came as a surprise. It's about the wedding of Steve Clark's daughter Jacqueline, where the Clark 3000, while outshone by the bride, did feature strongly on the day. It

seems like only yesterday when Ernie and Merle Clark joined the AHOC and I first met a 12 year old Steve Clark. Thank you to Steve for sending in some words and photos.

Have you given any thought about jacking up your car? It's not something that I like doing, although it's necessary. You will find an article on doing just that starting on page 19 and yes I would much prefer to use a hoist. Many thanks also to Robert Sassall for the article titled – *Restoration v Preservation*. I think it will cause many of us to think about what to do.

In this issue we have a couple of articles from names you have probably not heard of. Firstly on page 29 there is one by Perth based motoring journalist Bill Buys on the Austin A40 Farina rallied by Pat Moss and Ann Wisdom. Then there is an article on a trip to Cornwall by English writer Nick Maltby where he visited the home of Donald Healey. I found it most enjoyable and I hope you do as well.

Yes I have received the Quinn Austin-Healey back from having its paint attended to, but as there are plenty of photos of the car within this issue I won't dwell on it any further. Having said that what about the photo of the car below? Yes beneath that exterior does live an Austin-Healey and that exterior is what's called a Fiberfab body. Before I became interested in vehicles of the Donald Healey Motor Company, through the pages of *Road and Track*, I coveted the Fiberfab body style. You will find starting on page 15 a short article on one that's been for sale on eBay. The car below is another one that's currently running is Historic racing in the UK so I really couldn't resist using the photo here.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter* and I look forward to receiving your photos and words on what you have been up to during this extended period of lockdown.





Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 1 July 2021.

Commenced: 7:35pm.

Venue - Zoom Video Conference

ATTENDEES

Refer attendance list.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

There were no visitors or new members.

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, Glenn Barnes, Mal French, Colin Goldsmith, Christine Lyttle, David Mould, Caroline Quinn, Muriel & Ray Roberts, Doug & Pamela Ross.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 3 June 2021, as published in the July 2021 issue of *Flat Chat*, be accepted as a correct record of that meeting.

Nothing to do with the minutes, but Terry Bancroft thought that Patrick had let a golden opportunity go begging in FC by not captioning the article on Terry's new car "Banger's New Banger!"

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Gordon advised that the Australian Austin-Healey clubs had a Zoom meeting scheduled for 12 July, to discuss future national rallies.

The SA and Queensland clubs were next in line for 2021 and 2022 respectively, but both had decided to pass, for various reasons. That left the NSW Club next in the queue, for 2023.

Gordon advised that the Committee would be discussing the issue at their next meeting, but it was likely that NSW would offer to host a rally or mini-rally in 2023 or 2024. Hopefully most of the population would be vaccinated by then which would remove some of the uncertainty. If any members had strong views on the rally, he asked that they let him know before the 12 July meeting.

On the subject of rallies, Gordon reminded everyone of the mini-rally being run by the Victorian club this year, and the run he'd organised to meet up at the rally venue (in Mildura). He only had three other couples coming at this stage, so if he didn't get more interest, he would have to reconsider the run.

Patrick noted that if COVID hadn't interrupted proceedings, the Victorian rally would have been the 49th and therefore SA would have been the 50th, so he asked whether the mini-rally would be recognised as the 49th. Gordon was to ask the Victorian club for their view at the 12 July meeting.

Bruce offered his view that the Club could do a mini-rally in 2023, but thought that a full rally could result in financial stress for the Club if there was a lockdown. In his day job as an events manager he was all too aware of the possibilities of cancellation and the impact. Gordon thought we'd be OK if we included the appropriate disclaimers in the terms and conditions of the rally, plus there'd be less risk if most of the population was vaccinated by then.

Gordon was hopeful that the August general meeting would be able to be held at the Strathfield Golf Club.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Geoff had nothing to report apart from being cold and miserable.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie advised of snail mail received:

- The Australian Jaguar Drive – May & June
- 50th Anniversary booklet – AHOC Qld
- Five membership renewals
- And a mystery envelope with no contents!

Electronic magazines and newsletters received:

- Healeys West (WA) – June & July
- Speed Read (MSA) – June
- Rally Directions (CRC) – June
- The Preserve (CMC) – June (plus their May GM minutes)

Other emails received:

- Cooly Rocks On sent through some photos of their 2021 event, and a save the date for 8-12 June 2022
- East Hills Charity Car Show at Panania had been postponed to Sunday, 18 July
- A few emails from members having problems with logging into the website (forwarded onto Jim)
- Update from Targa Florio Australia on their event (15-18 November 2021)
- Introduction from a recently launched classic car and bike automobilia swap meet site called Gearshifter (forwarded to Patrick & Jim)



TREASURER'S REPORT

John advised that the accounts were for the end of financial year as well as the end of month, so he was already organised for the AGM!

Funds as at 30 June 2021:

Debit card	\$301.93
Main Account	\$17,850.03
Cash Reserve	\$12,500.08
Charlie's Run	\$2,254.02
Term Deposit	\$78,948.63

Interest earned for the month was a princely 11c.

Revenue for the month included Flat Chat advertising (\$750), sale of windscreens (\$520), membership payments (\$9,455) and deposits for the Mildura mini-rally (\$200).

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Bruce Ewan apologised for having forgotten to send his report to Patrick for Flat Chat!

Bruce was a bit concerned about the Model Park event for 25 July, as nobody had registered so he thought it should be postponed, but he was worried that members might just turn up on the day. It was noted that Patrick or Christine could email members if needed.

Bruce advised he'd send out confirmation emails about the Retford Park event shortly. He currently had 27 attendees.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim advised he'd put some events up on the website but he wasn't sure about the timing for some of them. Bruce was to advise if any changes were needed.

Jim said he'd also been talking to Ron Strange about how the library might operate and they had devised a plan about reserving books, and also wanted to do the CDs and DVDs. Following on from Gordon's suggestion that the Club use the cloud for CD and DVD access, Jim noted that the Club paid for storage through the website so he was planning on looking at the cloud for storage as an alternative.

MEMBERSHIP

On Christine's behalf, Gordon advised there'd been 104 membership payments to date.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick advised that Flat Chat had gone out the previous evening with one bounce-back.

Patrick noted that he had high resolution versions of the magazine available if needed. Gordon added that he thought Alan Mitchell was still printing and binding copies so he would need the high-resolution versions.

HISTORIC VEHICLE REGISTRATION

Patrick advised he'd had a couple of new people apply during the last month. At the end of July he would contact members on historic registration who hadn't renewed just to let them know as a courtesy that they needed to do something to keep their historic registration.

In response to a question from Jim, Patrick advised he had copies of the covers from the national magazine so would send them through to Jim.

HISTORIAN

No report

LIBRARIAN

No report

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

No report from Neville.

Gordon thought it worthwhile to remind members that the Club inspectors were volunteers who were simply helping members out, so please be understanding about their availability to conduct an inspection.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross confirmed that the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day had become a victim of COVID, so Gordon called for other auspicious Healey-related dates. Colin Rule advised that John Kent was coming up on 12 September to judge Colin's car. Julie thought this was a very good date as it was her wedding anniversary with Garry! Ross was to contact

Parramatta Park to see if the date was available.

Bruce Ewan offered 22 October as a possible date, this being the date that the Austin-Healey had been announced at the Earls Court Motor Show, in 1952. As the 22nd was a Friday, Ross suggested that 24 October could be the back-up date.

CMC REPORT

No report

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No report

CSCA REPORT

On Colin's behalf, Gordon advised that the MG Car Club were holding a Supersprint at Pheasant Wood

(Marulan) on 17 July, but they were struggling for entrants. Jim added that the details were on the Club's website.

REGALIA

Colin Rule advised of the windscreens he still had available, being 1 x BJ8, 5 x 100 and 2 or 3 x 100/6. He'd also sold that day a BJ8 sales brochure to Peter Flint

FOR SALE/WANTED

N/A

GENERAL BUSINESS

N/A

Meeting concluded at 8.35 pm.

FOR SALE

FOR SALE

FOR SALE

Free to Good Home - Four Vrederstein 195 70 x 15 tyres - Almost brand new.
Call Terry Bancroft on **0409 323 133**

3:5 Differential centre - if interested call Neville Stirton on **0414 472 877**

Colin Rule our Regalia man advised that the Club has the following windscreens for sale - 100 - four, 100/6-3000 - two and BJ7/BJ8 - one. Colin can be contacted on **(02) 4368 2938**

Austin Healey 3000 MKIII restoration project.

A fantastic start to a restoration project. Has a new Killmartin chassis with all inner panels, new aluminium guards, new aluminium bonnet, fully rebuilt motor, inspected diff and gearbox plus many, many new parts. Including, new radiator, new brake parts, new glass and rubbers, new clutch, new dash top, new fan, suspension rubbers, sway bar kit and more.

It has absolutely no rust and requires very little panel beating to be ready for paint. It's been taken down the road of being a works rally replica and it would be your choice to continue this way or put it more back to stock, it can come with the original bonnet if you prefer the non-louvred look. You'll save yourself a fortune over buying a rusty car and starting from scratch.

The car was a complete running car when disassembled and there are no missing parts to my knowledge. It comes with a Heritage certificate and receipts for all parts and work done so far. \$55,000.

Contact Darryl on **0412 618 023** or darrylcarthew@me.com



I am pleased to say that most members renewed their membership through to 30 June 2022, except for 22 who have not and therefore will not be receiving this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Four past members have advised that they are not rejoining.

Unfortunately, one of our members Robert Harrison from Whale Beach passed away recently and his son David Harrison has the Austin-Healey and has contacted me to have the membership changed.

Due to the Covid lockdown, the August General Meeting scheduled for Thursday 5th will not be face to face, but will be held via Zoom. You should have received an email last Monday with the link to join the meeting. The link is also repeated in the president's words found on page 2 of this newsletter.

Remember, we can only have your details correct, if you advise us and update them. So please keep me advised of your changes eg phone numbers, email addresses and home address to the above email.

Social Report

Bruce Ewan

0432 096 493

bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Social Activities August - Cancelled

The extension to the Sydney's lockdown now covering most of August ensures that the planned technical workshop of August 14 on "Fuel Injection" and "Improving Engines to Race Spec" will have to be postponed to another date. Likewise, the visit to the Auburn Botanic Gardens for the Cherry Blossom Festival.

Spring and warmer weather is not far off. With daytime temperatures over 20°C, blue skies and sunshine most days; it is not hard to imagine spring and a way out of the crisis that is currently plaguing Sydney.

I have my fingers crossed that the planned September events can go ahead. These will be a wonderful way to

Membership Report Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au



There have been a few issues for members in the website and these are slowly being rectified and payments should be able to be allocated correctly soon.

Don't forget to join the General Meeting on Thursday 5 August via Zoom.

Keep safe and well!

Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle

get out, enjoy spring, fresh air and celebrate once we have fewer restrictions. Given the situation re Covid and restrictions is changing rapidly, it is best to let me know if you plan to attend these events and then I can communicate to all those registered as each event gets closer.

Sat, 4th September 2021

Retford Park House and Garden Tour

<https://www.nationaltrust.org.au/places/retford-park/>

Three tickets are available. (27 registered to participate)

Sat, 11th September 2021

Patrick Quinn: Concours Workshop. Restoring and returning to factory specification and concours standards. Venue - 213 Seventh Avenue, Llandilo, NSW 2747.

Please register in advance and bring along a plate for morning tea if you can.

To book please contact Bruce Ewan at the above.

Nash-Healey at Le Mans





Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

After last month's flurry of activity, this month has been relatively quiet. While it's been slow for renewals, our number of vehicles on Historic Registration has risen to 209, of which 126 are marque vehicles.

As mentioned last month, it's an important time of the club year as June 30th was when memberships lapsed. There are very few rules for Historic Vehicle Registration dictated by Transport for NSW, but one is that you "must be a member of a recognised historic vehicle club". This means that if you let your membership lapse, your registration lapses with it. Of

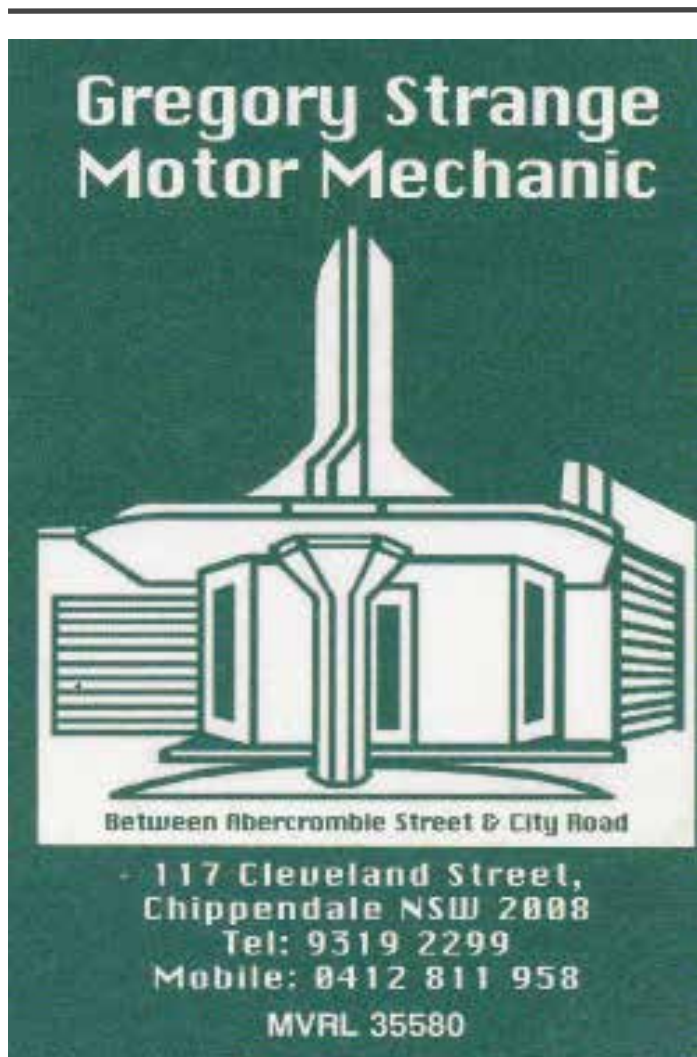
course you may have joined another club and changed the recorded details with Transport for NSW which is okay, but it would be good to let us know. Over the next few days I will be in touch with those who have not renewed their membership and have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration to remind them of this requirement.

I recently received a question about using your Historic Registered vehicle during periods of lockdown. Like most things with Historic Vehicle Registration the answer is simple, you use the vehicle in exactly the same way as you would use your fully registered car. In other words you use it for necessary journeys only, which is the same as your everyday car. The only extra step is to remember to fill in the log book.

If you need to do shopping, you can use your Historically Registered car providing you can show that you are going to Coles, Woolies etc. Just as it's not possible to drive your everyday car to Palm Beach for a coffee on a sunny Sunday morning, you can't do it either in your vehicle that carries Historic Vehicle Registration. However I will say that it's probably prudent to leave your Historic registered vehicle in the garage, as they do draw attention.

Please remember the steps when renewing your Historic Vehicle Registration:-

- Once you have received the renewal arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or volunteer AHOC inspection officer.
- Complete the left hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Include a stamped self-addressed envelope.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Webmaster's Report

by Jim Phillips



Being in lockdown forced me to a few things that was in the round tuit file, so here's a summary of the things you can look out for when you visit our website.

Cars

Firstly, for all of you who wanted to know what are the period modifications that can be made to your Austin-Healey to comply with the requirements for your H or J registration there is now a link in the Historic Vehicle Registration page.

Also, previously it was only possible to add your Austin-Healey as one of your cars. This has now been expanded to almost include all of our members' vehicles that are on Historic Registration. Thank you to Patrick for a list of all the types of vehicles that are registered through our club, but unfortunately a couple don't appear on the database so they must be extremely rare.

When you login, under the list of Members options is "Cars" which will take you to the cars that you have listed. Tap on "Add a car" and you will be presented with a form to complete. To find your vehicle on the database start with the "year" then the "make" and finally the "model" which should then give you a list of all the options of that model. Add a photo if you like and click the save option.

Photos

Thanks to Alan Mitchell I have a lot of photographs to go in the photo gallery from years gone by and rather than having them all take up space on the website I will change them around on a regular basis. Currently I have a few photos from the 40th anniversary of our club's celebration at North Ryde Golf Club.

As said, a lot of these photos are from past events and COVID restrictions have meant that not much has been happening for the past 18 months so if you've managed to get out in your Austin-Healey (I went to Beacon Lighting the other day) and your adventure is not something that you would write an article about for Flat Chat send please me a photo with a caption - <mailto:webmaster@austinhealeynsw.com.au> and I'll put it in the photo gallery so that the other members can enjoy.

I'm also creating a gallery of member's vehicles so would love to see those pics as well in the above email box.

Always grateful for reminders that need to be inserted on the site as well as your suggestions to make the site better although due to a couple of limiting factors, one being my inexperience and the other the constraints of the developer/host it may not be possible to implement.



A privately entered BJ8 in a Tulip Rally.



STOP PRESS

COVID CONFINES THE MILDURA MEANDER TO NSW

Well, there we were thinking we had bested the Covid Beast and then it comes roaring out of the airport and we are back in lockdown. Now I had thought to take us through the beautiful country around Bright and on to Echuca and Swan Hill before ending at Mildura for the Victorian AHOC's Mini-Rally. With the continuing presence of Covid and in trepidation of there being an epsilon variant not too far into the future (I think that is the next letter in the Greek alphabet) I have decided that it would be better for us to stay within NSW for this trip.

Now, even if you haven't booked yourself in for a great trip to Victoria's Mildura Mini Rally in November, you can still join us for the run to Swan Hill staying in NSW all the way, if we have to.

As previously advertised, and depending on where your journey starts, we begin with a longish drive to Jugiong on Friday 5th November where we will stay at the Jugiong Motor Inn. This is an older style motel, but clean and tidy and it has a well recommended restaurant bar and beer-garden, so we should be able to enjoy a welcoming drink and tasty dinner as we get together at our first stop. Jugiong is 336kms (3hrs30) from Sydney and, if you don't know it, Jugiong sits in a very scenic part of the Murrumbidgee valley.

On Saturday 6th November we will drive to Corowa (270kms ~3hrs) to the Wingrove Motor Inn. There are a number of pubs and restaurants within walking distance and a pizzeria for those who would like a casual dinner.

Sunday 7th November will see us wend our way from Corowa along the Murray Valley, following the river from near Corowa to Moama (230 kms ~2hrs40 via NSW, or 2hrs if we can cross into Victoria). At Moama we will stay at the River Country Motor Inn. As with Corowa there are pubs, restaurants and service clubs in town for dinner.

On Monday 8th November we will drive to Swan Hill (225 kms ~2hrs30) staying at the Murray Downs Resort, which is situated in NSW, a short drive from Swan Hill in the grounds of the Murray Downs Golf and Country Club. There is a bistro at the Golf Club

which has a similar ambience to Strathfield Golf Club. However, don't miss the Lake Boga Flying Boat Museum as you near Swan Hill. This is well worth a visit even if you have no interest in flying boats, but do check its opening times as at some seasons it closes at 4pm.

From Swan Hill, those who have booked into the Mini-Rally at Mildura will have a final leisurely 225 kms drive to Mildura. There is the main road route, or you can choose to follow the river via Nyah and Robinvale. Either will take around 2hrs30, thus allowing you plenty of time for a leisurely lunch before arriving at Mildura in plenty of time to check-in and register for the Rally.

Those who are not going to Mildura can take their own time and route for the return journey home.

The price for the four nights' accommodation will be \$270.00 per person. This is accommodation only. For this tour I am leaving the choice of food and payment to you.

Please don't delay if you would like to join us on this meander to Mildura (or Swan Hill). Confirm your booking with me (gordonl@aussiebb.com.au, or call 0403 198 343) and don't forget to pay your deposit of \$50 per person to the club by electronic funds transfer, including your name and reference 'Mildura', or 'Wagga', so I know which option you prefer.

If you can't add a text reference, most banks will allow you to add a numeric reference so please use your Postcode to help me identify your payment.

If you cannot do that, please deposit a cheque at your local Westpac bank payable to the Austin-Healey Owners Club NSW account detailed below and let me know that you have done so by email or phone.

Westpac Bank: BSB 032 669, A/c no. 277411
'AHOC Charlies Run'

Happy Rallying

Gordon Lynas

Clark Family Wedding – Healey Style



Father and Daughter Arrive

Recently, long time club member and second-generation Austin-Healey owner Steve Clark experienced a truly magical moment when his daughter Jacqueline was married. Jacqueline is also the granddaughter of long time AHOC NSW and Queensland club members Merle and Ernie Clark.

Among many of the magical moments were father and daughter arriving for the ceremony in Steve's 1960 BT7 3000 which he restored while Jacqueline, and her sister Sarah, were growing up.

Jacqueline often "helped" her dad in the garage when she was young and enjoyed many of the milestone moments in the re-building of the car. As can be seen from this series of photos.

Now, some twenty plus years later it was fitting that Jacqueline arrive at her wedding in a car that has been such a constant part of her life. She and Sarah are third generation Austin-Healey people and the great news is there is a fourth generation of Clarks on the way to continue the legacy....



Jacqueline helping dad when she was three.



A little older and awaiting the test drive.



Out with dad for a run.



The 3000 preped and ready.



Pride of place at the reception.

Cont from P1

Someone recommended a sparky to help and he was a lovely guy who fitted me in mid-next week at short notice. It wasn't cheap, but he was well recommended and had the electrical innards of a late model Range Rover on his floor – I figured he could handle a DR3A.

With one day to spare, I collected the car from the sparky at 6pm with the job complete. Wiper was working on two speeds. All good, but disaster on the way home. The brakes were sticking again and getting materially worse the more I drove. Apparently, the handbrake cable was not the issue.

Straight back to my mechanic Friday morning, and with one day to spare, spent an hour walking around under the car checking all potential causes. Issue was RHS brakes would bind and not release until the car has sat for 20 minutes. A web search and test confirmed that the cause was a collapsed brake hose. There was no time to get one up from The Healey Factory so I approached the good people at Chatswood Brake and Clutch (02 9413 3166) and they whipped up a replacement in an hour.

I finally had my car ready with four working hours to go before departure at am the next day. Phew!

The next few days were truly magic.

We met at Thornleigh Maccas. My venerable BJ7 'Shcappelle', my mate Ross in his immaculately prepared TR6, Michael owner of an amazing PRB Clubman chickened out and drove his hairdressers MX-5. Our mates Charlie and Peter as passengers

and Peter D joined us later with a Hyundai van as chase car.

Day One. Took us all the way from Thornleigh to Tamworth via Wollombi and Scone. On Day Two was a circuit through Gunnedah, Werris Creek and Quirindi, then back to Tamworth. Day Three saw an absolutely beautiful run, down Thunderbolts Way through Gloucester to Forster.

On the fourth day we attempted to run the back roads to Armidale, but it came a cropper in Bellbrook, where the road was washed away, so we returned to the coast and ran to Coffs and then via Bellingen up



the breathtaking Waterfall Way at sunset arriving to a big party house (BNB) in Armidale in darkness.

Open Road Dramas

One day it was raining lightly, so I tried my trusty new wipers. The switch seemed unfamiliar – I swore it had previously worked clockwise and friend Charlie noticed that the park wire was hanging loose – my sparky had put that one in the too hard basket. However after a little hesitation, they seemed strong, so we relaxed, until the burning smell started, and



Scott Graham with his
BJ7 behind him

Cont' next page

Cont'



the wipers, well the wipers stopped. Fortunately, the rain also stopped, and we continued safely.

Sadly, that day we lost the TR6 along the way. Running roughly, she stopped altogether in Nowendoc. A combined ~120 years of English car fettling experience was not enough, and she had to be parked up in the local dairy <https://www.lia.net.au> who looked



after us with refreshments and stories before we headed off. That night the assembled anoraks pulled my wipers apart, found the wiper rack assembly was loose, causing friction which burned the motor out. My expensively recommissioned DR3A was dead. The next day, Ross headed back to Sydney and took my trailer up to retrieve the Triumph.

Day five started innocently enough, we spent the



morning checking out Armidale, starting the run to Coffs Harbour after lunch. With Rainex on the windscreen, I could manage the driving without too much drama. Until the heavens opened on the Gleniffer Road dirt track from Bellingen to Coffs. It was super tricky – head out the window stuff for a couple of hours, but we got there in the end.

The run home via Black Head was uneventful, except for a great hour ogling the assembled Ford Flat-heads (about 50-60), Harleys and etceterini gathered for the annual Rattle Trap IV run up Crowdy Head Beach. <https://barringtoncoast.com.au/whats-on/rattletrap>

My wiper problems notwithstanding, I was proud that my old gal was still running strong at the end.

Postscript

Ross retrieved his TR6 and now has the motor out and undergoing a rebuild at home. Now the motor will be as strong as the box, brakes and everything else on his lovely TR6. Nice man that he is, he decided to rebuild my wiper motor using a spare armature. Two weeks after the run, we fitted it to the car with the self-park working a treat and the switch back to its correct clockwise configuration. The wipers work better than ever. He's quite the perfectionist – even documenting the wiring with a natty diagram and notes.





Found this online and thought it would be of interest with our warmer weather approaching. Patrick

Healey

Healey Automobile Consultants Ltd.
Four High Street,
Barford,
Warwick CV35 8BV,
Tel 0926 624 383

To the Editor,

ENGINE COOLING

25 October 1991

Ref. No. 3003

I recently visited a well known restorer of Austin Healeys who complained bitterly about the difficulty he was experiencing in trying to keep the water temperature down on a competition vehicle. A quick look under the bonnet revealed the cause of the problem was the complete lack of any baffling around the radiator. If restorers do not understand the problems involved I felt that I should explain our past findings on the subject.

In the late fifties we were investigating what appeared to be cooling problem in high ambient temperatures. We took over the paint shop and raised its temperature and put the car in it. We then measured the time it took for the engine to boil when idling. The time was very short. Testing a larger capacity radiator or larger fan produced little improvement. We then checked air circulation at many points around the radiator with an anemometer and found that the fan was drawing air through the radiator and that much of this heated air then moved round the sides of the radiator and was drawn through again. The use of smoke (a pipe will generate enough smoke) will make the circulation of air readily apparent. It was apparent that very little fresh air was being drawn through the grille at the front. We then experimented with baffles fitted to ensure that the air that had passed through the radiator could not get round to the front of it again. It was also found that air passing through the radiator could also return over the top and under the bottom of the radiator.

Suitable baffles at the side of Austin Healey radiators are often left off or bent away to ease radiator fitting and this causes a hot running engine.

MG workers often bent the baffles to speed production but Syd Enever managed to ensure that cars left the factory with correctly fitted baffles. Garages always bent baffles to ease radiator fitting. Fitting a larger fan without correcting the baffle fitting will only worsen engine heating. The cooling fan action causes the air pressure to rise in the engine bay and to decrease (pressure) in front of the radiator. Air then flows from the high to the low pressure region.

Before going to the expense of fitting larger fans or radiators or spending money with a specialist, ensure that your car has efficient baffling.

We rarely used fans on competition vehicles but relied on efficient ducting and baffling to make sure that the vehicle's forward motion generated sufficient air flow through the radiator. The very efficient ducting ensured that the last racing Sprites we built used very small radiators and raced in high ambients without any cooling problems.

Geoffrey Healey

Tasmania Tour - 2022

At the request of the AHOC I have been asked to organise another Tasmania Tour in 2022.

If you wish to express your interest, please contact Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133, or (02) 4777 4883 or bangers@bancroft.id.au

You may pull out up to around December 2021 with nil loss.

This will definitely be the last Tasmania Tour that Pat and I will be organising.

Itinerary

February 6th -	Departing Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania
February 7th -	Breakfast at the Edgewater Hotel Devonport
February 7th & 8th -	Overnight stay in Burnie
February 9th & 10th -	Overnight at the West Coaster Motel Queenstown
February 11th-14th -	Overnight at the Old Wool Store, Hobart
February 15th & 16th -	Overnight Bicheno
February 17th & 18th -	Overnight Casino Launceston
February 19th -	Depart Devonport for Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania

All mornings will include either a continental or a full breakfast depending on where we are.

Fiberfab Austin-Healey



US magazine Road & Track was my required reading during the late 1960s and early '70s before my attention was drawn to English sports cars.

I vividly recall lusting after the body styling on offer by the many fibreglass body manufacturers that placed their ads in that august publication.

The one that really took my fancy was Fiberfab that offered bodies for proprietary chassis such as Triumph, MG, Jaguar and Austin-Healey. Yes it is hard to understand today why anyone would choose to fit a fibreglass body to an Austin-Healey, but then it was a different world and our cherished cars were just yesterday's sports cars.

Fiberfab was formed in 1964 in Wisconsin making accessories and body parts. They soon realised that their market was in California and moved to Palo Alto, between San Francisco and Los Angeles.

Understandably their new products were made for the Corvette, but soon that made body kits for Jaguars and VW. The mid-1960s saw them introduce a body called the Banshee/Caribee that could be fitted to the chassis of donor Triumph, MG and Austin-Healey. Two years saw the release of the Jamaican that many likened to the Lamborghini Miura.

Finances were not good for Fiberfab but the name continued under different owners continued into the 21st Century when it appeared to have finally been wound up.

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Fibrefab cont'

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Period Advertisement



Austin-Healey 3000 GT

Like so many re-bodied cars they are generally purchased by well-intentioned but generally under-financed enthusiasts resulting in unfinished projects languishing in home garages. So I was pleasantly surprised to see a very nicely finished example come up on eBay in Washington state, USA.

It states that it was re-bodied in 1967, but it's not a BJ8, but more likely to be a BT7 Mk1. It also states that it has been recently restored and looks it. The car ran through the eBay auction system and reached US\$35,200 (Aus\$47,725) with 22 bids and didn't sell. So it was relisted, but didn't attract a single bid.

In the small print at the bottom it states that it will be auctioned at a MECUM Auction scheduled for August 10-11-12 Monterey California. The link is <https://www.mecum.com/lots/CA0821-465082/1967-austin-healey-gt-coupe/>



Interesting things on eBay



A front shroud badge for the 100, 100/6 and 3000 Mk1. A steal at \$248 when you can find one at AH Spares for \$115.69

A really nice Lucas SLR576s, rally hand-held spotlight. It was listed for \$125.00 and didn't sell.



A NOS Lucas centrifugal switch for your early 100 BN1. It sold for \$50 which was a steal.

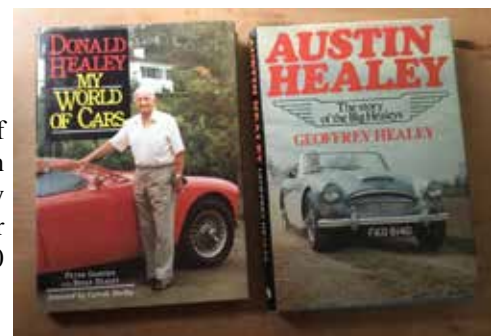


A new BJ8 front shroud badge for \$350. While it might be original you can buy one from AH Spares for \$243.62.



A tool kit with mostly original tools and reproduction bag for \$1,412 plus \$226 postage.

A couple of well known Austin-Healey publications for \$90.00



A 100, straight off the dragway (well perhaps not) less engine and gearbox for US\$5,000 or Aus\$6,740.



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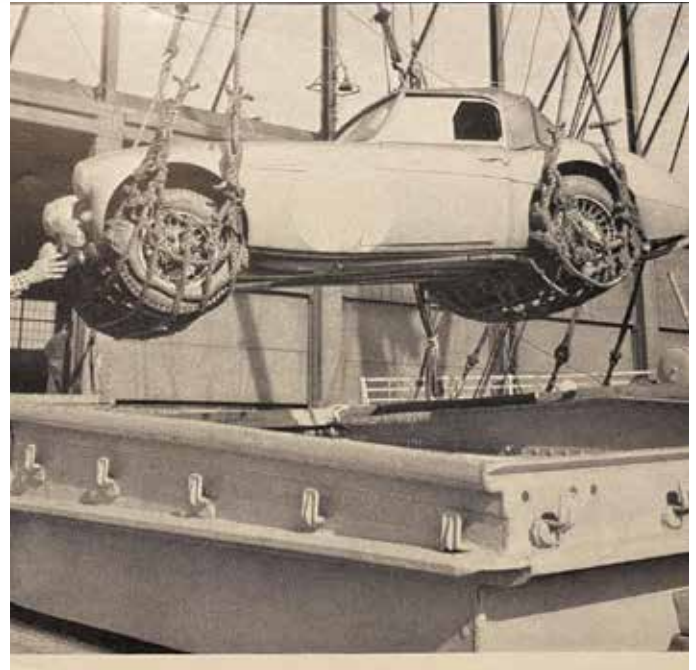
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In the days before roll-on/roll-off this is probably how your Australian delivered Austin-Healey arrived on shore. Going on the door lock this is a BN4, but the racing roundels can't be explained.

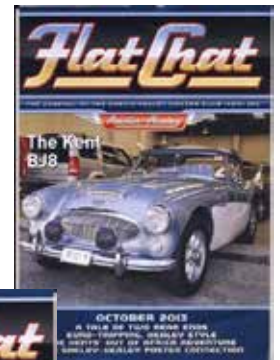
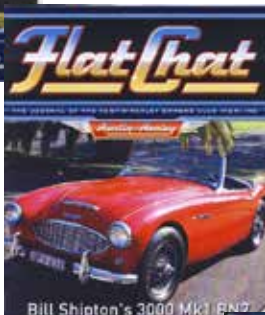
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NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (& stamp) at a meeting.



Jacking

by Patrick Quinn

I really don't like jacking up a car; however I dislike the thought of being caught underneath or worse, even more so. Some years back I had a BMC Mini jacked up and you guessed it, down it came. Thankfully there was no one underneath, but it still gives me the shivers thinking about it.

Recently a club member who has his Austin-Healey parked in a small garage asked me what the best way was to jack up his car. Frankly I was surprised to be asked what I thought was a straightforward question, but then I thought about what was involved and it occurred to me if there was one thing about Austin-Healey ownership that has been highlighted by our workshops, was that some members have never seen the underneath of their cars, let alone actually have gotten underneath.

When I bought my first 100 in 1972 there was no jack at all in the boot. Not that the original Shelley Jack was of much use anyway, as given the circumstance that you will need to use it, it will never be able to fit under the car. So blessed with the ignorance of youth I went out and bought a bottle jack which I still have, but normally it sits as an ornament in the workshop. I should have bought a scissor jack which can fit under a low to the ground Austin-Healey.

I persevered with the bottle jack through to the late 1970s when I bought a hydraulic trolley jack. Why did the Mini come tumbling down? I was using the trolley jack and attempting to lift on a metal to metal basis.

So what is the best way of jacking up an Austin-Healey?

When I bought the 100 I knew next to nothing about the mechanics, and some would say that things haven't changed much. So I phoned around and asked a few well experienced fellow members how they did.

They all said to start at the front. A few years back I jacked up on the driver's side and then 'CRACK!' as the main leaf on the passenger side rear leaf broke. The springs were well past their use by date with bushes on both sides worn to non-existence. New rear springs are now fitted to the Quinn Austin-Healey.

Everyone said that while it's important to get your car high enough, what is more important is safety. NEVER TRUST A JACK! So make sure that you have a decent set of jack stands to support your car once it's up in the air.



Con't next page

Jacking cont'

Cross Member

Look underneath and that front cross member is perfectly positioned to place a trolley jack underneath. **DON'T THINK ABOUT IT.** On so many cars I have looked at over the years past mechanics have thought the same which has resulted in a dented, split and eventually rusted cross member.

Find yourself a stout piece of timber that is the same length from the outside of the two chassis rails. Now remember my new trolley jack that was just as good



Lift away with your jack until the front wheels are off the ground and the timber is high enough so you can place the stands under the ends. Doing this spreads the weight along the timber and avoids any damage.



as Eric Outhwaite's new shovel? Did I mention that it has a rubber pad on the end of its arm? No metal to metal contact.

Position the jack under the piece of timber and lift so it's pressed up to the chassis. Then loosen off the knock-ons or in the case of our car loosen the wheel-nuts. Always best to bang away at a knock-on with the tyre on the ground so that shocks caused by the hammer are not absorbed by the suspension.



Jacking cont'

Now the Rear

If you have a trolley jack (especially one with a rubber pad) place it under the differential and lift up the rear end. If you are still persevering with a scissor or bottle jack or the like place it under one of the rear springs and jack up high enough to remove the wheel and slip a jack stand under the spring. Lower the jack and repeat on the other side. If you want it a little higher you may have to enlist the help of a few piec-

es of timber to go between the jack and the spring.

So your car is high enough to get underneath for cleaning and working on or whatever. Now have I ever told you about my garage folding creeper?

Still not a job that I really enjoy doing, but it's sometimes a necessity.

Do I wish I had a hoist?





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Remember - NRMA Motorfest Australia Day Sydney

By Alan Mitchell



From the late 1990s until the early 2000s the NRMA sponsored a display of historic and classic cars in Sydney to help celebrate Australia Day.

Centred around Hyde Park (north) and down Macquarie Street, the display was limited to applications from car clubs and numbers were restricted due to space availability. It meant that you could display your car free on Australia Day from 8:00am until 4:30pm.

Approved applicants from car clubs were required to meet at the Domain parking station before 6:00am, then to be formed into groups and paraded from the Domain along William Street, Elizabeth Street, Bent Street and finally Macquarie Street and into St James Road, Prince Albert Road and College Street. An amazing display of classic and historic vehicles.

The best part of the day was the arrival. Our club was lucky to be able to attend and we enjoyed the drive in especially the early morning "tunnel runs" through the Beecroft, and Harbour tunnels or the run down York Street at 5:30am, the noise from the unique Austin-Healey exhaust was truly amazing and today stays in my mind. Along with other AHOC Club members, I attended this event each year from 1998 until 2004. Then in the mid-2000s then NRMA withdrew the hosting and the event was then transferred to Parramatta Park.

A couple of the photos from the event as well as the badges that we received are attached.

I did attend a couple of Australia Day events at Parramatta Park, but this had so many other displays occurring, as well as the lift off of hot-air balloons, that any car display seemed to pale away.

However in the scope of things, the early morning drive through the streets of Sydney in an Austin-Healey to attend that Australia Day Display was truly magic and a great memory.



A Cornish Healey Odyssey

By Nick Maltby

Since becoming involved with the Warwickshire County Record Office's Healey Motor Company Archive project, in 2016, I have become immersed in the fascinating story of how Cornishman, Donald Healey founded his eponymous car company in his adopted Warwickshire. In June 2021, I persuaded my wife that we should spend a few days in Cornwall, checking out all the sites, in that county, that I have read about during the past five years.

As you will read, we encountered a couple of disappointments, but since arriving home and putting what I was able to see into context, I am absolutely delighted with what we did see and can record here.

Most Healey, Austin-Healey and Jensen-Healey enthusiasts are very familiar with the story of how Donald Mitchell Healey, born in Perranporth, Cornwall, in 1898, became interested in cars, especially driving them, at a very early age. That interest was inspired and encouraged by his father, John Frederick, who was a member of Cornwall's relatively small number of car owners in the early years of the 20th century. His parents John Frederick and Emma (nee Mitchell) allowed Donald to convert a storage shed next to their "Red House" general groceries store, Boscawen Road, Perranporth, into a garage/workshop.

However, before I race ahead of myself, let me share with you the trip's itinerary and consequences –

Perranporth

As mentioned above I knew that the Healey story began in Perranporth, so, clearly, that popular seaside town was the first name on the list of places to visit. There was another, more recent, reason to visit Perranporth: the stained glass window installed in the town's St. Michael's Church of England Mission Church as a memorial to DMH. The window was paid for by the Donald M. Healey Memorial Fund that had been established by North American Healey Clubs led by the Austin-Healey Club of America. Donations had been and still are made to the Fund by members of Austin-Healey Clubs around the world. Donald's second son Brian (Bic) organised the design and installation of the window in conjunc-

tion with the Church authorities. Bic and his wife Mary lived on the outskirts of Perranporth so were well placed to undertake this work. We found St. Michael's Church and I was able to take the photos shown below.

I knew that Donald's parents had a grocery store in Perranporth: I had done some pre-trip research and discovered that the "Red House" store is now operated by the local Co-Operative Society. A Co-Op store was almost the first building we saw as we entered Perranporth and I convinced myself that this had been built on the site of the 'Healey' shop and therefore, took some photos. It is a good job that I walked up the main shopping street (Boscawen Road) where I discovered another Co-Op store, I took photos of that too. It was only when I returned home and did more research that I realised it was the second Co-Op encountered that now occupies the 'Red House'. That name features in the store's trading name. Incidentally, the store had been founded by Donald's maternal grandfather, Sampson Mitchell and John Fredrick and Emma Healey, Donald's parents, continued to run it after Sampson retired.



The Donald Mitchell Healey CBE Memorial Window in St. Michael's Church, Perranporth.

Cornish cont'



A photo of the Memorial Window in context. It is important to acknowledge that this window is installed in an active Church of England establishment. The left lancet depicts St. Piran who brought Christianity to North Cornwall from Ireland. The middle lancet shows, at the top, a representation of the Oratory that St. Piran established in the sand dunes at Perranporth (the site is still preserved). At the bottom is a figure of a Miner, representing one of Cornwall's main industries in the past. The right lancet shows the figure of a fisherman, representing Cornwall's other (and existing) main industry.



The "Red House" Perranporth, Cornwall, as it is today. The corrugated iron fence to the right of the shop is where Donald's garage used to be.



The 'Red House' (Sampson Mitchell store) With Donald Healey's Garage next door, That's Donald on the right in the doorway. It is highly likely that the charabanc belonged to Donald too because he used to run charabanc trips. Photo Credit – Perranazabuloe Museum.



St. Michael's Church, Perranporth



An artist's impression of the recently approved redevelopment of the "Red House", Perranporth, Cornwall. See reference to it in the Healey Cyder Farm section below.

Cornish cont'



Sampson Mitchell's "Red House" Store with Donald's Buick Roadster outside. It was in this car that he had his first motorsport success – A speed Trial in 1922, organised by the nascent Truro Motor Club of which Donald was a founder member. Photo credit – Royal Cornwall Museum.

Healey Cyder Farm

My renewed ** interest in Healey cars began with me watching a TV series in early 2013. The programme, presented by British actress Caroline Quentin, was called "Cornwall with Caroline Quentin". In it, she made several visits to the Healey Cyder Farm and reference is made to the fact that the enterprise was started by David Healey, son of Donald's third son, John, who unlike his older brothers, Geoffrey and Brian, was not involved in his father's motor company. In fact, in his early years, he and his wife Joy ran the family's "Red House" store. John's family still own the "Red House" and in 2019 obtained planning permission to redevelop the site into a multi-story building with retail units on the ground floor and holiday flats on the upper levels. It was fortuitous that I chose to visit Perranporth this year because this historic building, as regards its Healey connections, will no longer exist next year.

Needless to say, we visited the Healey Cyder Farm which has been successfully developed into a tourist attraction. When we arrived, at just after 11.00 am., the main car park was already pretty full. I had picked up a Healey Cyder Farm information leaflet from our hotel; I was surprised to find no reference in the leaflet to the small collection of Healey and Austin-Healey cars proudly featured on the Farm's website. I thought that this omission was because the marketing people, who designed the leaflet, wanted to concentrate purely on what the visitor might see in

terms of cider production and the products thereof. It didn't cross my mind that I wasn't going to see the cars, which, if I am honest, was the main purpose of our visit. In checking in at reception, I asked the young man "where can I see the cars?" His reply was "I am sorry but the cars are not on display they have been put into storage as a response to Covid". I was disappointed, but on reflection, was still pleased that we made that visit, if only to witness what a great success this branch of the Healey family is making of its chosen line of business.

**My first job, as a junior draughtsman, was with Jensen Motors, which, at the time, was making the painted and trimmed bodies for the Austin-Healey 3000. In 1967 I bought a new Austin-Healey Sprite Mk.IV. I only kept it for a couple of years before I went to the U.S. on a twelve month contract with Chevrolet.



Healeys Cyder Farm's Wind Turbine. I am sure that this would have pleased and amused Donald, given his own efforts to develop a portable wind-driven generator.



A Healey production line. But one for cider, not cars!

Cornish cont'

**Barrel making or cooper tools from yesteryear.****Healeys Cyder car collection as it was in 2019.
Photographed by Ash Blagdon**

Trebah House and Gardens

Donald and Ivy bought Trebah House in 1963. It has 26 acres of gardens and a private beach (Polgwid-den Cove) that leads onto the Helford River. They lived there for ten years during which time Donald put the outbuildings, near to the house, to good use. It was here that he and Roger Menadue, who had also moved back to Cornwall, worked on the prototype of what was to be known as the Austin-Healey 4000. That car was fitted with a Rolls-Royce FB 60 (3.9Ltrs.) engine, also used in the Austin Princess R. Other products of Donald's active mind, during this period, were electric organs and wind-powered generators.

This quotation is taken from the Trebah Garden Trust website –

During World War Two, Head Gardener Robert Day and a reduced staff did little more than maintain the garden. The beach was concreted and the boathouse and rocks were dynamited to allow access for tanks. The garden was used as an ammunition store, and trenches dug in the lower part of the garden.

On 1 June 1944, a regiment of 7,500 men of the 29th

US Infantry Division, along with their tanks, guns and transport, embarked from Trebah Beach in ten 150-foot flat-bottomed LST landing craft. For five days they battled through enormous seas to the Isle of Wight and then on to the D-Day assault landing on Omaha Beach in Normandy, where they suffered grievous casualties.

A memorial at the bottom of the garden commemorates the courage of these brave young American soldiers.

During his stay at Trebah, Donald organised the removal of much of the concrete that had been laid down by the Americans. The concrete had been laid to support the tanks and armoured vehicles that were to be loaded onto the landing craft. He was able to fund this work with a grant from the War Department. He also built the existing boathouse with granite, which had been used as hardcore on the beach.

As we were in Cornwall it made sense to pay a visit to Trebah. I had always thought that Trebah was close to Perranporth on Cornwall's north coast. In fact, it is 20 miles due south, on Cornwall's south coast. In making that trip we encountered our second disappointment: We travelled on a Thursday only to discover that the gardens are closed on Thursdays and Fridays. It is only the gardens that are open to the public, the house is privately owned. As it happened, the disappointment was mitigated by the existence of the coastal path which runs past the bottom of Trebah Gardens and above the private beach. I took full advantage of that as you can see from the photographs shown below.

**Trebah House from the 'Coastal Path'**

Cornish cont'



Trebah Gardens Plan



Mallard Pond at the bottom of Trebah Gardens



The beach at Polgwidden Cove. The remains of the WWII concrete slipway can be seen at the top of the beach.



Above and below. 29th US Infantry Division at Trebar during WWII. Photo Credit – Trebah Garden Trust



US Landing Craft at Polgwidden Cove being loaded with equipment before sailing to Omaha Beach, Normandy, France.

What a very interesting trip that was. In many respects, we only just skimmed the surface of the Cornish Healey story. A historian/Healey enthusiast could probably spend two weeks in Cornwall visiting all the sites we visited and more: most importantly visiting the various museums and libraries to unearth more photos and data featuring Donald and the Healey and Mitchell families. That historian/Healey enthusiast could be you! I hope that I have whetted your appetite.

Blue Plaque at the DHMC



When I first heard that a 'Blue Plaque' was going to be placed at the sight of the former cinema I did scratch my head as I wasn't familiar. I suppose we have similar things in Australia, but I'm not aware of them.

A quick check on Google revealed that "*A blue plaque is a permanent sign installed in a public place in the United Kingdom and elsewhere to commemorate a link between that location and a famous person, event, or former building on the site, serving as a historical marker.*"

I wonder if there is a blue plaque located where Gough Whitlam was born.

Anyway thanks to Nick Maltby for the below.

A 'Blue Plaque', marking the site of the Healey Motor Company's, Coten End, premises (a former cinema) was unveiled on Saturday 3rd July (DMH's birthday) by Warwick's Mayor, Richard Edgington.



Healey Court, Warwick, built on the former site of the Donald Healey Motor Company.

In case you're wondering, the cinema was occupied by the DHMC from 1963 to 1974, but the original site in use beforehand is now occupied by a building used by Austin-Healey restorer JME and called The Cape Works. (See below)

I do find it curious that Alan Jones and I visited the cinema in 1975 and it was still signed as the Donald Healey Motor Coy.



Here's Zoey

By Bill Buys

In case you thought Pat Moss and Ann Wisdom spent all their time rallying an Austin-Healey 3000, nothing could be further from the truth.

They were contracted to the BMC Competitions Department to drive what they were asked to. This little story tells that when a car was touched with the Moss/Wisdom moniker it's in demand just like the Big Healeys.

Launched back in 1958, Austin's A40 Farina was a radical change from the historic British brand's A30 and A35 models and turned out to be a top seller for BMC.

While the cute little A30's design was an in-house effort from the pen of Dick Burzi, and basically a scaled down version of the A40 Devon of 1952, the A40 was designed by Pinin Farina in Turin, Italy - and was one of the first modern hatchbacks.

It was a fairly basic machine with a 948cc BMC A-series four-cylinder engine that in standard form produced 34bhp (25kW) and 50lb (68Nm) torque, but it had neat, clean styling, used little fuel (38mpg or 7.4litres/100km) and was a popular economy car of its day.

However the little BMC motor was also highly tune-able, and the car weighed only about 800kg and it wasn't long before a few started to appear on racing circuits. And not just in the A40, but also in the Austin-Healey Sprite and as a Formula 3 engine, especially in Cooper cars. Nowadays one or more racing can often be seen competing in historic production car races at places like Goodwood.

There are few A40s left in Australia, where they were assembled at BMC's Sydney plant, and they were also built in Mexico, South Africa and The Netherlands. Most, however, came from BMC's Longbridge works in Birmingham. Worldwide a total of 342,162 were produced between 1958 and 1967.

So what's one of the few survivors worth today?

That depends on condition, but we reckon a good one should fetch around \$4,000. However, a couple of months ago, one fetched \$68 short of AU\$84,000 at a Bonhams auction, in England.



What made it special was its history. It was dear 'Zoey', the 1958 model with registration XOE 778 and chassis no. AA2S62642: it was the A40 Farina prepared by the BMC Competitions Department in which Pat Moss and Ann Wisdom won the ladies prize and 10th overall on 1959 Monte Carlo rally.



Given Pat Moss' propensity of naming cars, XOE immediately became known as 'Zoey' and though she disappeared from the scene for a some years after her giant-killing performance in the Monte, Practical Classics magazine editor Paul Skilleter bought her in 1978 and chose her as the publication's first big project.

Farina Cont'

Why?

'She was a typically common British saloon,' he said. 'One with a special history. The rebuild called for care and attention to detail and we were meticulous in preserving as much of the original metal as possible. It was a lengthy process.'

Once restored, Zoey was developed for historic rallying and swept the board in the 1985 Coronation Rally with Paul Skilleter and Paul Rosenthal at the controls.



Then it was acquired by an Irish enthusiast who agreed to let the magazine folk borrow it for the 40th anniversary of their publication in 2020.



Next, the owner decided to sell Zoey. She came with a good file and log book, with images and stamps documenting her extensive history. The documen-

tation shows she competed in five events in 1992, including the Donegal Historic Rally, Cork Historic Rally and the circuit of Ireland History Rally. The A40 was featured in the first issue of Practical Classics magazine and 40 years on she was again be on the cover to celebrate the magazine's milestone.



Today, the car is in a good and usable condition and retains many historic and original stickers. Overall, the bodywork is solid and presents well, Bonhams said, adding that there are small blemishes 'as you would expect with a competition car.'

'Inside, the interior is purposeful, but shows that it has been put to good use, and comes equipped with roll cage and bucket seats.

'The car offers a new owner the rare opportunity to own a piece of history, with the option to use the car as is or further enhance the performance and return to the rally stages in anger once more.'

The new owner has not been identified, but what is clear is that Zoey has for most of her life had a heck of a lot more muscle under her bonnet than the original 34 horses.

Still, \$84,000?



RESTORATION V PRESERVATION

Story: Phil Hall. Prelude: Elwyn Jordan. Photos (except Ferraris): Elwyn Jordan.



The car on the left is a 1922 Model T Ford that was on display at Berry earlier this year. (I had this photo of the car in my report on that day).

The amazing thing about this car is that it is totally original – unrestored! You can see, even in this smallish photo, the areas where the paint has worn through and the under-coat showing; the rusty sections on the mudguards and so on. It's a magnificent old car! Just imagine how good this will look when it

is totally restored! But is that what should be done with it? If it was mine, as much as I would like to “make it look pretty”, and restore everything to original or better, I wouldn't. I would keep it exactly as it is, a testimony to a car that has survived for 97 years without undergoing a total rebuild. And I suspect that is what its owner is doing.

This is a perfect example of the question of whether cars should be restored or preserved. You'll see them at almost every show (except Concourse shows): cars that have just been driven and driven, accumulating decades of wear-and-tear, bumps and bingles. Every mark, every dent, is a signature from decades of service on the roads. Should they be restored? Or left as they are? Obviously if the car is badly decomposed, or in pieces, (I remember somebody describing how he took delivery of a vintage motorbike: he said he “loaded it with a shovel!”), then there is no question – restoration is the only option. But if it is all together and serviceable?

A friend of mine, **Phil Hall**, (who is a local motorcycling identity, and also has a long-time association with cars and car racing) wrote an article on this topic some time ago. I've been waiting for an opportunity to put it in the magazine, but it's a bit long for the printed version where space is more limited, so I will put it in this email version. This month presents a good opportunity, as I don't have a swag of extra photos from runs or displays to put in. So here it is.

Elwyn Jordan



This is a Ferrari; but it isn't just *any* Ferrari, it is a **1964 Ferrari 250LM**, one of a rare breed of European thoroughbreds built by Ferrari to win the Le Mans 24 Hours race. And, rare as they are (there were only ever 33 built) this particular LM is even more special. It was bought by Sydney motoring journalist, the late David McKay, and was raced in Australia and Asia under the banner of Scuderia Veloce, a Sydney exotic

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car dealership. Famous names such as Sir Jackie Stewart, “Big Pete” Geoghegan, Andy Buchanan, Spencer Martin and others drove this car in sports car races and endurance races until the late 1960’s when it was increasingly uncompetitive and was retired. (The photo is of Pete Geoghan racing it at Bathurst in 1968).

In David’s care, the car was cosseted and cherished as a significant part of Australia’s motor racing history. However, as David aged and he eased into retirement, he began to think about selling the car, which he finally did. The asking price was spectacular, rumoured to run well into seven figures and, as such, it was always likely that the car would find its way overseas where the big money is. And so it was that the American billionaire and collector, Ralph Lauren, was named as the car’s new owner. What happened next is tantamount to criminal activity!

Lauren had the car taken to his workshop where it was completely restored.



Worn parts were replaced, body panels made new and every trace of the car’s incredible racing provenance was systematically and completely stripped away. What emerged from this million dollar process was a brand new, shiny, 1964 Ferrari 250LM. And thus an irreplaceable piece of Australia’s motor racing history was lost forever, for the car that now adorns Lauren’s museum is *not*

the Scuderia Veloce LM any more. In his dying years, David confided to my brother that, had he known that Lauren was going to destroy his car he never would have sold it.

So, restoration or preservation? It is no surprise that, over the last 50 years or so, the Americans have led the way in over-restoration. “Blessed” with a wad of money and often a paucity of good taste, the American car restoration business had succeeded in rebuilding thousands of wonderful cars of yesteryear to standards that far exceed what the car was like when it was new. Pebble Beach Classic Car Show, the “epitome” of this process, features cars on which literally millions of dollars have been spent and they are paraded before the adoring crowds as if they somehow represent the very best of 1930’s, or whatever it was, motoring. In fact, all that they represent is that the degree of bad taste is roughly equivalent to the depths of the pockets of their rich and obnoxious owners.

So, imagine my delight last night when I was watching one of my favourite shows on TV, “Chasing Classic Cars.” For those of you who haven’t seen it, it is hosted by Wayne Carini, a native of Indianapolis who now runs an exotic car dealership in Connecticut, USA. (*I couldn’t find it – must be on Fox or something. Elwyn*). Wayne is the real deal, a finder, restorer and seller of old and classic cars as well as a facilitator for owners who wish to sell their cars and want the best advice as to how to do it. I have long been an admirer of the honest and forthright way he conducts his business and the “reality” of the show compared to what passes for reality TV these days. Last night’s episode featured Wayne trying to sell three old, unrestored cars that have been part of his private collection, as well as seeking to purchase two similarly conditioned cars for two of his clients. And the venue for this episode was the Bonhams auction at the Simeon Museum, a museum that features a full collection of old and classic cars that are distinguished by one feature; all the cars are unrestored.

It was wonderful to hear the director of the museum say that, for the last 60 years, car enthusiasts had been going in the wrong direction, spraying millions of dollars at cars instead of leaving them the way that they were found. I nearly jumped out of the chair and cheered! The subsequent auction, of totally unrestored and original cars, was, according to Carini, a great success and the Bonhams representative who said that this was their first attempt at such an auction, seemed equally pleased.

In the process of the story, he appeared to coin a new term that should be applied to cars and vehicles of this type. He talked about “Preservation” as opposed to “Restoration.” I immediately thought that here was something on which it was worth remarking. What should have been done with David McKay’s LM? It should have been **preserved** rather than **restored**.

The other side of the Lauren coin is to be found right here in Australia in the excellent collection of historic Australian racing cars maintained with such loving care by the Bowden family at Buderim on Queensland’s Sunshine Coast. Here is a “time warp” collection of cars whose owners are painstaking in preserving the racing patina of their collection and maintaining the cars in “as they were” condition, even down to stone chips, minor accident damage, frayed upholstery, etc.

Restoration? In some cases, as in completely derelict barn-find cars, it is necessary, but it should only be to the level of what the car’s condition would have been as new, not over-restoration. **Preservation?** Vastly preferred. It seems the movement is gathering pace in the USA; let us hope that it takes on here as well.

Phil Hall

SOME EXAMPLES OF UNRESTORED CARS



1963 Studebaker Lark – unrestored.



My (Elwyn) 1974 Triumph – unrestored.